



The XML version of your stock vector graphic is shown in the right pane

be launched by pressing [Shift] + [Ctrl] + [X].



Draw freehand and regular paths

As with any other graphic editor, arbitrary shapes can be drawn using the pencil tool. Use [F6] to select pencil (freehand tool). On the other hand, it is also possible to draw regular shapes if freehand is not your cup of tea. Regular shapes can be drawn using Pen tool ([Shift] + [F6]). The pen tool, unlike pencil, creates sharp nodes, which don't have any curve handles. If you still want to create a smooth Bezier curve, just click and drag using the pen tool. The following line will then have two collinear opposite handles. Transform these handles to give the line your preferred shape.



Combine or break apart compound paths

If there are two or more sub-paths, Inkscape considers each of them as an individual path. These paths can be combined into a compound path by selecting two or more of them and hitting [Ctrl] + [K]. To split a compound path into separate paths, press [Shift] + [Ctrl] + [K].

Note: Since the path has only one fill and stroke, all paths in a compound path will get the style of the first object being combined.



Convert any shape or text to path

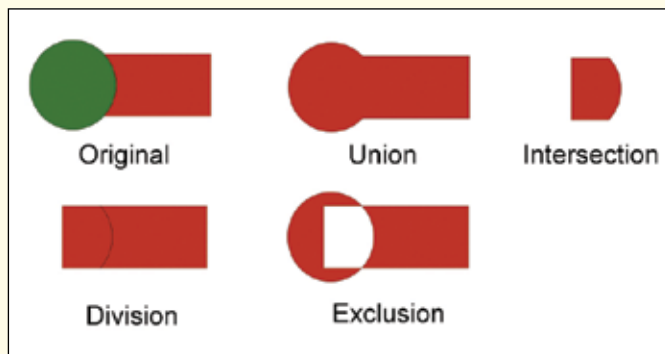
You can convert a shape or text to a path by using [Shift] + [Ctrl] + [C]. Converting an object to a path will cause it to lose its original properties. That means you can't edit the text or modify the corners of a rectangle if you convert it to a path. However, all the path properties – nodes, handles, Boolean – are added to it.



Combine objects using Boolean operations

Boolean operations such as 'Union', 'Intersection', 'Difference' and others can be applied to two or more paths. To apply a boolean effect, first you need to convert it to a path. Let's look at each of these operations:

Union: This operation clubs two or more objects into a single object. To do this, select two or more objects and hit [Ctrl] + [+].



Boolean in the works

Intersection: Intersection, as the name suggests, intersects two or more objects. [Ctrl] + [*] is the necessary hotkey.

Exclusion: Unlike most other Boolean operations, Exclusion works only with two objects. It subtracts the common portion between two overlapping objects. In addition to this, two additional nodes are added where the paths intersect. Hotkey: [Ctrl] + [^]

Difference: This operation subtracts the second object from the first object. Difference is again possible only with two objects. Select two objects and hit [Ctrl] + [-].

Division: Division adds the edge of the overlapping object to the underlying object and removes the rest of the overlapping object. Hotkey: [Ctrl] + [/]



Put text on path

The simplest way to put text on a path is by drawing a path or an object and converting it to a path. Then, with the text tool write something, select the text as well as the path and select 'Put on path' option located under 'Text'.



Lighten a path using 'Simplification' command

The 'Simplification' command reduces the number of nodes on a path while still almost preserving the object's shape. Usually, paths drawn using the Pencil tool have more than one unneces-

sary node. Reducing the nodes not only makes the path light, but also adds a smoothening effect to it. The simplification tool is best used for reducing system load. To apply simplification, select the path and hit [Ctrl] + [L].



Increase simplification threshold

The amount of simplification is called the threshold. It depends on the size of the selection. That means a large object will simplify insistently over a simple path. Simplification threshold can be increased by pressing [Ctrl] + [L] in quick succession (where the time between two calls is less than 0.5 seconds). With this, each call that follows has increased threshold over the preceding one.

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Finding popular software

If you like discovering new software under different categories, you should have a look at File-Hippo. They have a good categorisation of software that lists out the most popular ones at the top and also has maintain a section that only displays recently updated software.



Using Ninite to grab the latest software updates

We all know how easily one can download and install software in bulk via Ninite. For those not in the know, Ninite is a little utility that bundles together the software that you need into a neat little executable file that